

The 5-Minute Backyard Food Plan

A simple printable worksheet that maps your yard into growing zones and tells you exactly what to plant first based on your space — so you start with a plan instead of guesswork.

Why Small Backyards Actually Have an Advantage

Big acreage sounds great until you're the one mowing, fencing, and irrigating all of it. Small yards force you into intensive methods — square-foot spacing, vertical growing, and tight rotations — that produce more food per square foot than sprawling traditional gardens ever do.

The Three Systems That Matter Most

Self-sufficiency isn't one skill, it's three working together: food production (vegetables, fruit, herbs), small-scale protein (rabbits, quail, or chickens where allowed), and preservation (so a good harvest doesn't go to waste). Most beginners only tackle the first one and stall out.

The Mistake That Wastes an Entire Season

The single biggest reason backyard growers quit isn't pests or weather — it's planting everything at once with no plan, then getting buried in June and giving up by August. A simple written layout and planting calendar fixes this before it starts.